



Doc-Ock in Spider-Verse sequel

In a deleted scene, Liv survives being run over by a truck and dives into the multi-verse portal.
<https://digit.in/may19-45>



Dark Season 2 details

Netflix sheds light on Dark Season 2 with new teaser and premiere date.
<https://digit.in/may19-46>

Boo April!

Because why hate one thing when you can hate it all!

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I

'm an equal opportunity hater, so boo all the other months as well! However, I feel some explanation is

necessary as to why I went from hating a topic to hating an entire month... Well, as it turns out, when you try and be proactive and go to Ed with a list of topics to write this column about, he decides that instead of you having to fill in one page, why not do two pages instead and cover all of the topics listed? Needless to say I now hate the idea of being proactive as well.

Since I couldn't be bothered to find out the chronological order of events, I'll start with the one that got me into this predicament in the first place. Thanks for nothing Samsung. By doing exactly what I wrote about in my March 2019 column (written in February during MWC), and making the Fold into a hardware nightmare, suddenly there seemed to be more interest in this silly column than I ever wanted. Can't a guy just get on with life doing as little as possible and trying not to be noticed by anyone?

When you predict something in tech and it actually happens, you tend to have Eds take notice of your work and start questioning you, asking for more... I say asking, when of course I mean 'demanding by using threats of ending sources of livelihood'. Thus, in a bout of fear, I spurted out four or five ideas when all he wanted was

one good idea, and that is how I have ended up here, having to do double the work as usual! :-(

Unless you've been living under a rock, you should know that in April we found out that early review pieces of the Samsung Galaxy Fold were suffering from dead screens, or half-dead screens. While some of it was caused by over enthusiastic reviewers yanking off a layer of the screen thinking it was a screen guard (it wasn't), some

with disgust. When I had my good pal Agent 001 call me up and tell me to make sure not to update my Windows 10 PC, I knew something was amiss. Turns out, I owe him one, because I'm a paranoid updater (I check for updates for everything daily). On my home PC of course, I couldn't bothered if my work PC was hacked or died... that just means more tea breaks until someone else figures out the problem – and this being Digit, that someone else is usually everyone, because no one but me can resist a bout of troubleshooting here. Seriously, one error message in any gizmo, and the whole team jumps up to come have a look and then dig into error logs and whatnot to try and find the cause. If I was evil (I'm not, I'm just lazy),

I would sabotage a few systems just to sit back and watch no one doing any work, just like me! Anyway, I digress, as usual – only because digressions fill up words, and then I have less to write. (*wink*wink*).

Turns out a bug in a Windows 10 update caused drives to be remapped, which in turn can break a lot of software and require you to re-install them. In extreme cases, one might even need to do a format / reinstall! Why does this happen? It's not clear, but it turns out that any PC which tried to update with a USB drive connected, would cause the drives to be re-mapped to add in that USB drive as a fixed drive letter.

The support site says, "Inappropriate drive reassignment can occur on Windows 10-based computers that have an external USB device or SD memory card attached during the installation of the May 2019 update. For this reason, these computers are currently blocked from receiving the May 2019 Update.", and

culture

BOO-MAN

puma and Tetrax collab
 After the success of Puma's 2018 SS19 Switch, Tetrax has announced that there will be a new Puma Switch. Stay tuned to <https://digit.in/may19-47>

Chris Hemsworth as Hulk Hogan
 Hulk's (Chris Hemsworth) will join WWE's Raw Superstar Hulk Hogan in his upcoming Super Show. Stay tuned to <https://digit.in/may19-48>

Bend...and snap!

A classic case of "what were they thinking?"

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Yes, I'm aware I missed "foldable" phones in December. But that was before we actually got to see the stuff that people like Samsung, LG, Huawei and others actually launched. You'd think they'd have me eating humble pie for my rant, but instead I can now inform you, things are far worse than even I imagined!

The one thing I hate about all big launches is the hype built around them. I guess I'm old school and prefer that a product creates its own hype by just being that good, rather than big flashy events trying to convince you that every little ordinary feature is mindblowing. Damn you Apple for popularizing this ridiculousness.

Now, you've already read enough about what Samsung launched before MWC and what others launched at it, and perhaps have read multiple opinions about what was good or great about the new phones. I'll throw my hat into the ring and say I think the Galaxy S10s are refreshing, and I'm very tempted to buy one. I think I will

have some liver left to donate... it is a good thing that they regenerate.

The S10 model is currently pointless for India, because although many manufacturers are trying to make their flagship phones future-proof, I don't think we will see proper 5G networks before 2020, at which point there ought to be newer models that will be far more powerful and perhaps even be much better value for money. Buying a 5G phone today is like buying an HKTV, looks good on paper, but you're paying so much more for features you just cannot use, that it is a pointless waste of money.

And that leaves us with the Fold... Bendable, reliable and foldable displays have been spoken of for over a decade now, and there are plenty that were shown off at MWC this year. Samsung has beaten the others to launch, but that by no means is all there is to it. These displays are technically bendable displays rather than foldable displays. If you look carefully at the launch video (since no one has hands-on with the device so far) you will see that the Galaxy Fold doesn't, well, fold. At the point where the hinge is, there's a rather large gap, where the display curves and bends. Over the next few years we expect to see this solved in some way, and no doubt we will eventually get proper foldable displays, but that isn't the case now.

Huawei's Mate X prototype (shown off at MWC) seems to hide this bending-and-not-folding flaw better by bending the display outwards instead of inwards – ending up with a much larger display than the Galaxy Fold, both when folded up and also when opened out. However, the point to remember here is that the Mate X has one screen. What this means is that, when folded up, the Galaxy Fold has a proper "back" of the phone, while the Mate X when folded up has screens on both sides, which makes it prone to scratching and fingerprints. With the Fold, the main screen is always protected when folded in your pocket or bag.

The price of such pioneering devices is going to be sky high, and thus, they're not really something that's meant for you and me to own. As "luxury" devices, they're essentially meant for people who want to burn money to try and be trendy. Besides, they're bound to be buggy, and the few numbers of devices sold will translate to rather pathetic app support.

Hardware trouble might also rear its ugly head, as it usually does when there is an all new category that hasn't really been proven in the market yet. Folding and bending and hinges meant moving parts, and that means wear and tear... something we haven't had to deal with for ages. We might very well be talking fast about bending and more about snapping soon – thus the headline, and the silly Legally Blonde screen grab.

For now, at least, I think all this folding screen business is overhyped. I'm sure a few tech generations (about 3 years) from now things will be very different, but if you hear anyone going on about foldable displays, do me a favour and slap them back to reality will you?

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